

Redesigning the Finviz S&P 500 Map

Replacing color-encoded change with ranked, comparable bars and a linked, colorblind-safe D3.js redesign

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STATS 401: Data Acquisition and Visualization
Individual Project – Visualization Critique and Redesign

BEFORE — Finviz S&P 500 Map

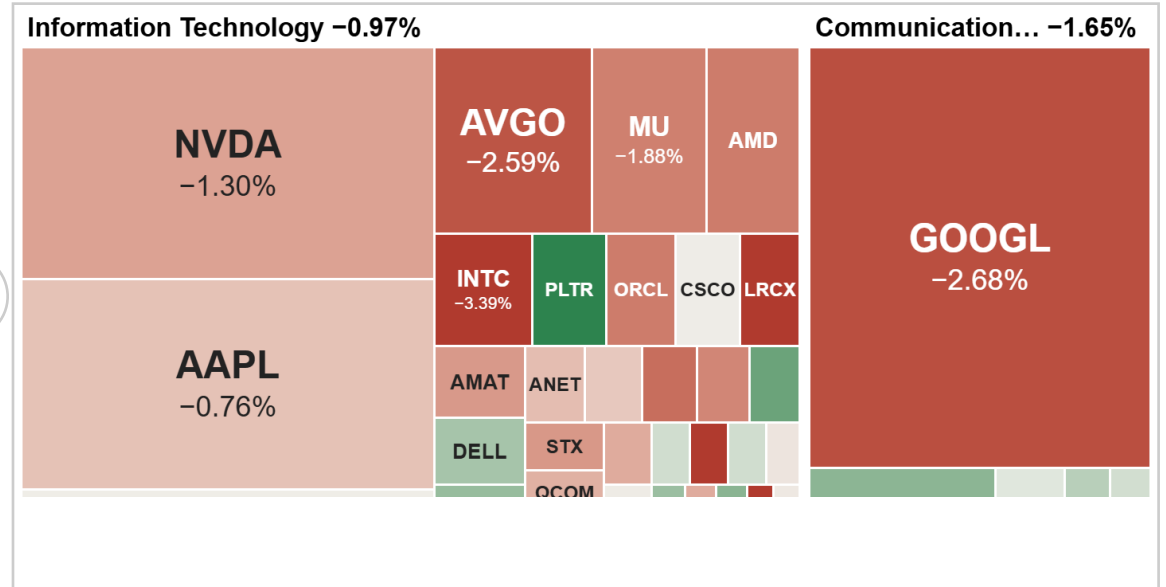
Tile size = market cap, tile color = daily % change



- **Competing channels.** Size and color carry two variables; only color has the real message, so the eye lands on the biggest tiles, not the biggest movers.
- **Imprecise color.** A red tile could be down 0.5% or 3% — exact values need a hover.
- **Cap-weighting distortion.** A few giant companies can color the whole map, hiding what most companies actually did.

AFTER — Interactive D3.js Redesign

Change moves to bar length & position; color only marks sign



- **Change gets its own channel.** Daily % change reads from bar length and a zero line, so sectors and companies can be ranked precisely.
- **Flat, sign-only color.** One green, one red — color never repeats what the bar already shows, and a colorblind-safe palette is one click away.
- **Weight toggle, breadth, and compare.** Cap- vs. equal-weighted views and a live breadth count expose distortion; a compare panel lines up any companies across sectors.